

RFI for integration of Anaplan with Fluence

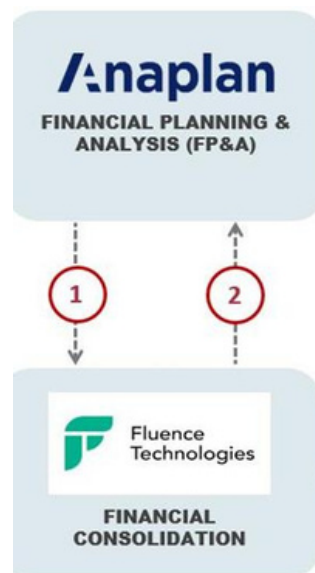
Background:

Anaplan recently bought Fluence Technologies, here is the news:

<https://www.anaplan.com/news/anaplan-announces-agreement-to-acquire-fluence-technologies/>

Requirement:

To setup a bi-directional integration between Anaplan and Fluence.



Key Requirements:

Data Flow from Anaplan to Fluence:

- Planning data (e.g., budgets, forecasts, actuals) from Anaplan should be transferred to Fluence for financial consolidation.
- Mapping of Anaplan dimensions (cost centers, entities, accounts, time periods, etc.) to Fluence's consolidation structure.

Data Flow from Fluence to Anaplan:

- Consolidated financial data (e.g., consolidated actuals, eliminations, adjustments) from Fluence need to be fed back into Anaplan for variance analysis, rolling forecasts, and reporting.

Automation & Scheduling:

- Data transfers should be automated and scheduled based on reporting cycles (e.g., daily, weekly, monthly).

- Ensure auditability and version control to track changes in financial data.

Error Handling & Validation:

- Data validation before ingestion into Fluence/Anaplan.
- Notification alerts for failed integrations.

Security & Access Control:

- Ensure role-based access for finance, IT, and business users.
- Secure data transfers with encryption and authentication.

Technical Considerations:

Data Mapping & Transformation

- Chart of Accounts alignment between Anaplan and Fluence.
- Handling multi-currency conversions and eliminations for consolidation.
- Hierarchical mapping (e.g., Entity → Business Unit → Region).
- Time granularity alignment (e.g., Anaplan might have weekly granularity, while Fluence consolidates monthly).

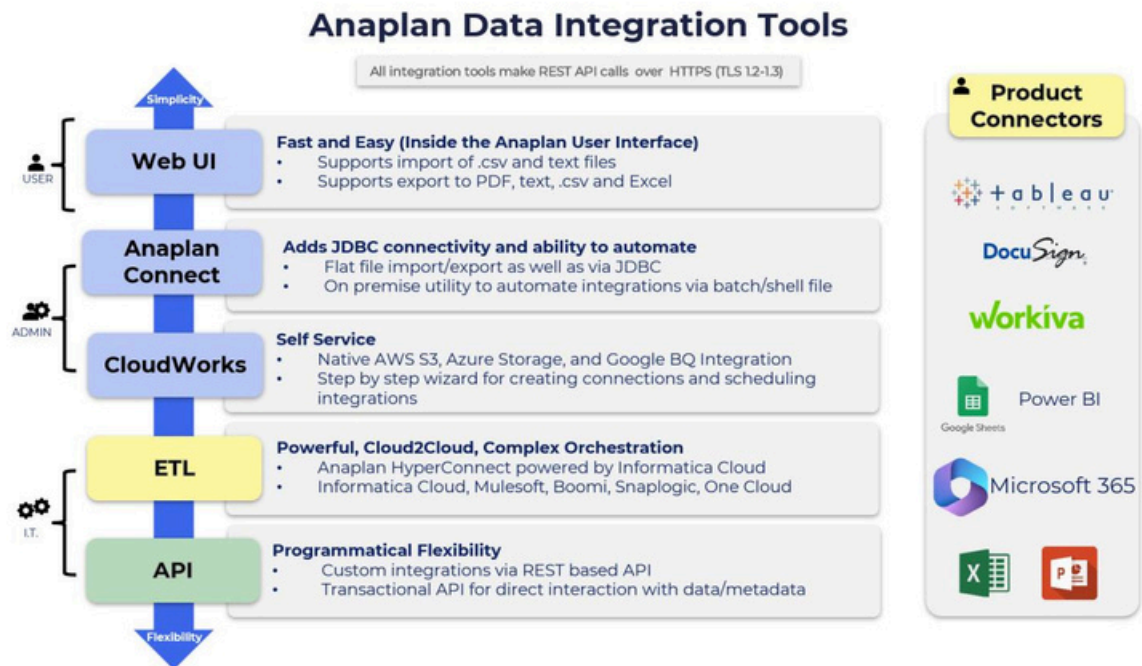
Performance Optimization

- Optimize batch sizes for large datasets.
- Ensure delta loads (only send updated data instead of full loads).
- Implement caching & indexing for faster processing.

Security & Compliance

- OAuth 2.0 Authentication for API access.
- Data encryption in transit (HTTPS, TLS 1.2).
- GDPR, SOX, and IFRS compliance for financial data.

Anaplan :



Fluence :

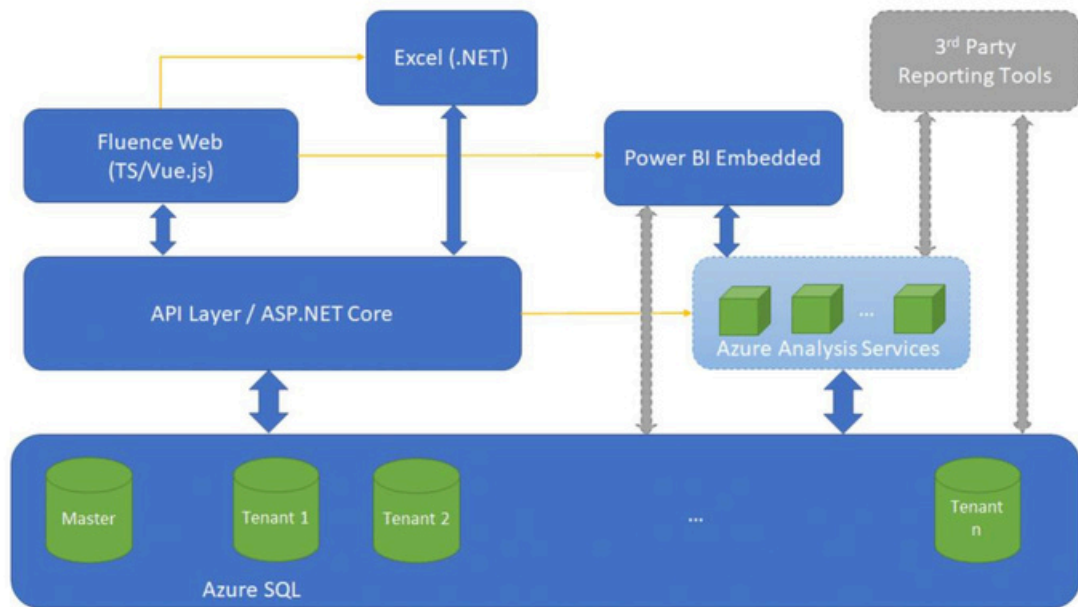
The Fluence platform is a multi-tenant, Microsoft-based application stack built on the Microsoft Azure cloud platform, leveraging Azure's security, services, and scaling options

Fluence is a software as a Service (SaaS) offering. On the server-side, there is a Fluence application server and an Azure SQL managed database.

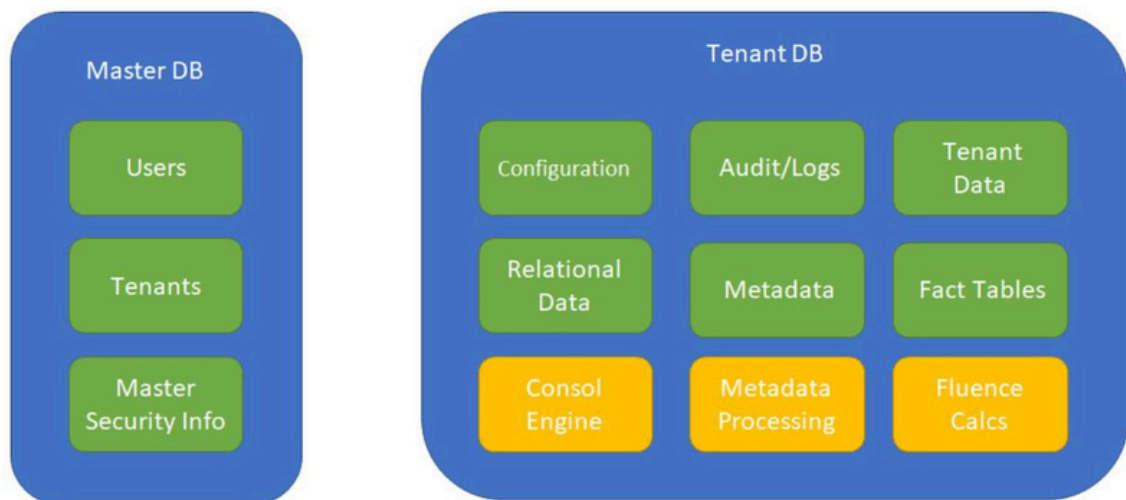
There is a master database that is used to store users, security, and tenant information. For each customer environment, there is a tenant database. Within the tenant databases, there are a set of standard tables, as well as tables that are customer-specific.

The web client communicates with the server via the API layer. The web client is also used to launch Fluence forms in the Fluence Add-in. This Add-in also uses the API layer to communicate with the Fluence server.

It is possible to set up Azure Analysis Services so that you can report on data through Power BI Embedded Analytics or other third-party reporting tools.



Below is a look at the database component in more detail.



Tenant : Each customer instance has its own database instance that consists of database tables and stored procedures.

There are several tables in each tenant database.

Table Type	Description
Application Tables	Tables controlling application functions, such as ETL, Security, and environment.
Dimension Tables	There is one table for each dimension and an alternate hierarchy.
Fact Tables	There is one fact table for each data model. These tables store the keys to the dimension and measure values, ultimately storing the data for the data model.
Staging Tables	These tables are used when importing data. Data is temporarily stored in the staging table before it is mapped and imported to the Fact tables.
Rules	There are consolidation rules tables that control consolidation processing.

Stored Procedures

The same set of stored procedures are used for all customers. These are not updated or customized as part of an implementation. This allows Fluence to offer out-of-the-box processes and calculations, including FX conversion, consolidation, variation, periodic calculations, etc.

In this lesson, the following objectives were covered:

- What is Fluence Consolidation - Fluence is an out-of-the box solution that brings enterprise-level functionality to mid-market companies to speed their close process and improve the quality and transparency of financial information. Fluence Consolidation includes pre-defined templates, reports, input schedules, and out-of-the-box models.
- The Fluence system architecture - Users interact with Fluence through a web-based application to launch Fluence Consolidation forms through Excel. Workflow is used to assign users specific tasks, configure email notifications, add approvals, and automatically kick-off tasks that can be automated.
- The Fluence database architecture - On the server-side, there is a Fluence application server and an Azure SQL managed database. There is a master database that is used to store users, security, and tenant information. For each customer environment, there is a tenant database.

Given here are the integration options with Fluence.

Option 1: Export by an end user in excel/ PDF format on local machine:

The screenshot shows the 'Self Service Report' interface. On the left, there are filters for Currency (USD), Entity (Total_Group), Scenario (Actual), Intercompany (Total_Group), Movement (Closing balance), Measure (Amount), Audit (Local Reporting), and DataView (All Values). Below these filters is a table with columns 'Account' and 'Date'. The table data is as follows:

Account	Date
	+FY2023
+ Current Assets	683,656,369
+ Non-Current Assets	440,518,214
- Assets	1,124,174,583
+ Current Liabilities	317,329,716
+ Long Term Liabilities	111,263,870
- Liabilities	428,593,586
+ Equity Attributable to Shareholders	695,580,997
- Stockholders Equity	695,580,997

On the right, a dropdown menu is open, showing options: Submit Changes, Refresh, Save To Repository, Save Custom View, Print, Download Excel, Download PowerPoint, and Toggle Slicer Task Pane. A 'Fixed' label is also visible next to the menu.

Option 2: Direct export by an administrator from backend (explorer) path:

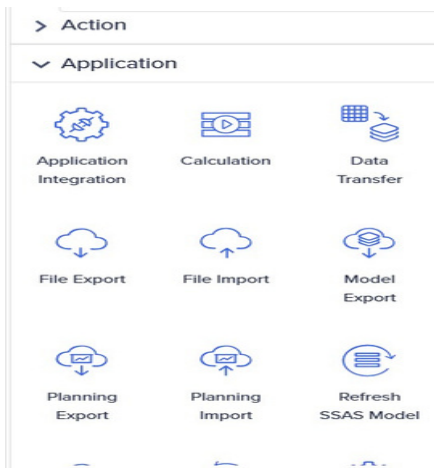
The screenshot shows the 'Explorer' interface. The breadcrumb path is: Explorer > Consolidation > Reports > Anaplan Reports > Published Reports > Financial Statements. The main table lists various reports with columns for Name, Type, and Date Modified. The reports listed are:

Name	Type	Date Modified
Balance Sheet	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27
Balance Sheet Comparative Report	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27
Cash Flow Statement By Entity	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27
Consolidated Financials - By Audit	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27
Consolidated Financials - By Entity	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27
Financials - By Audit Details	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27
Forward Financials	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27
Income Statement Comments	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27
Income Statement Comparative Report	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27
Operating Income Comparative Report	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27
Profit on Inventory	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27
Statistical Data Input	XL3	2024-07-08 19:25:27

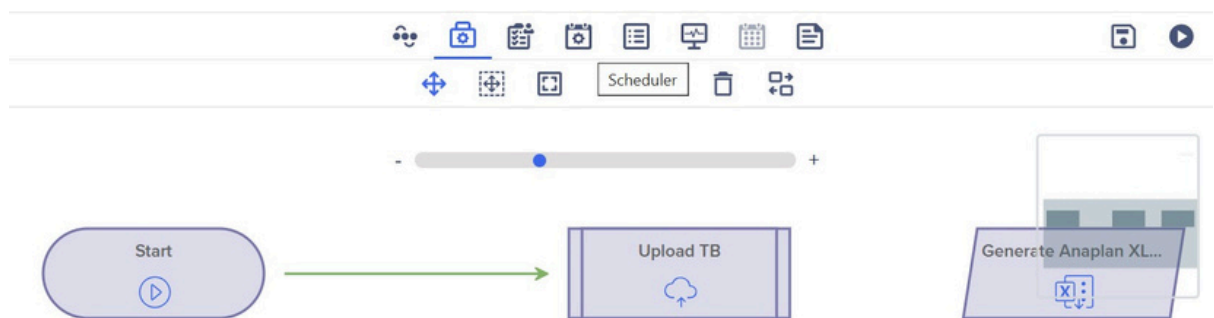
An 'Export As' menu is open, showing options: PDF, Excel, and Powerpoint.

Option 3: Creating export as an action and using workflow to run the export:

- Can use either whole model or specific file for export action:



- These actions can be scheduled for running as per preferred time slots:



- The file can be saved on server at the specified path or can be directly saved as a staging table for further transformations, along with timestamp:

Model Export 4 (Model Export)

Type ☒ Model ☐ Model View

Model Consolidation

Destination Fluence Explorer

Target File Name ☐ Add timestamp to file name ☒ No timestamp (Overwrite)

Folder

Format CSV

Compress Output ☒

Detailed Requirements:

- Setup a bi-directional integration between Anaplan and fluence
- Error logging
- Scheduling capabilities

Expectations:

- Setup Costs
- Infrastructure requirements
- Handover of the source code
- Testing using Real Data

Evaluation Criteria: